

THREE SIGNALS YOUR CLIENTS' COMPETITORS ARE ALREADY MOVING ON

What we caught in *functional beverages* this month

Each month we monitor the functional & non-alc beverage space continuously — so your team doesn't have to. Most "trend reports" recycle the same headlines. Below are **three signals with the data behind them**, including one most agencies in this space haven't flagged yet.

01

Functional soda is eating kombucha's lunch

MOVING FAST

The threat to kombucha brands isn't other kombucha — it's **functional soda**. Olipop and Poppi are growing **50–100% year-over-year**, delivering similar gut-health claims with just 2–5g sugar and a soda-familiar taste, at **\$2.29–2.79** — undercutting kombucha that sits at \$3.99 with 8g sugar. Faced with both on the shelf, shoppers increasingly pick the soda.

Why it matters for your clients: a kombucha or fermented-drink brand that keeps selling on "fermentation" is losing to brands selling on *taste, low sugar, and price*. The repositioning fight is happening now — Health-Ade already launched a "Plus" line to answer it.

READY-TO-SEND EMAIL ANGLE

“Same gut benefits, half the sugar — meet your new everyday can”

02

Fiber is the quiet growth engine no one's branding around

UNDER THE RADAR

This is the one most agencies haven't flagged. Fiber- and prebiotic-based sodas hold only **~6% of the beverage market** but are driving **27% of category growth** — what analysts call "overcontribution relative to size." And brands are moving past generic "fiber" claims to **name specific sources**: cassava, soluble corn, inulin agave are the fastest-growing.

Why it matters for your clients: the winners aren't saying "high fiber" — they're making one named ingredient the hero of the story. A brand that claims a specific fiber source first *owns* it before the category catches on.

READY-TO-SEND EMAIL ANGLE

“Why we put cassava fiber on the front of the can (and our competitors didn't)”

03

"Functional stacking" is raising the bar on every label

SHIFTING EXPECTATION

A single benefit no longer impresses. Consumers now expect **layered function** — kombucha is being fortified with prebiotic fiber *on top of* probiotics, and the "second wave" stacks precision strains, postbiotics, and adaptogens. Single-claim drinks are quietly starting to read as dated.

Why it matters for your clients: a one-benefit product needs its story re-layered before it looks behind. Either reformulate toward stacking, or **reframe an existing benefit as a stack** the audience hadn't noticed — often the cheaper, faster marketing win.

READY-TO-SEND EMAIL ANGLE

“One can, four things your gut actually wants”

WANT TO SEE THE FULL PICTURE?

The complete *Monthly Intelligence Report* goes deeper — and arrives ready to use, not ready to read.

Every month we compile a full briefing for your clients' exact niche — scored opportunities, ready-to-use templates, and ad angles. Reply if you want to see what it looks like for one of your accounts.

Reply to *see a sample report*

We'll follow up within 2 days

- EVERY MONTHLY BRIEFING INCLUDES
- ✓ 4–6 scored opportunities

✓ 3–5 email templates

✓ 2–3 ad angles

✓ Real-time alerts